

1 Text for an invitation and guidance to participants

Invitation

Please dial in at the day before the meeting at [TIME] for an opportunity to test your kit and receive guidance if you need it. Also feel free to email [NAME] if you have any concerns or questions.

There will be a 15 min 'reception' before the meeting, as people dial in and get sorted.

Many of us are new to this so please don't feel under any stress – we are all learners

Before – guidance to help you prepare

- Dress appropriately from head to toe! You don't want to make the classic mistake of getting up at break time and everyone seeing you're not!
- Check what your camera will see behind you. You are inviting your colleagues into your house so work out if you are comfortable with what they will see. Mistakes can be silly posters, unmade beds, dubious books, mess and clutter!
- Think about light on your face – is it too bright or too dark? If the main light source is behind you, turn off lights or close curtains to stop being a silhouette.
- In advance please alert the people you live with that you are having a professional meeting. Remind them on the day and we suggest you put a sign on the door so they know to keep the door closed and noise down.
- Depending on internet connection speed, please advise the people you live with that you need the internet connection so high demand streaming of TV or online games will not be possible.
- Check the temperature of your room (home offices are often less used rooms, or garden offices, and may get too cold for longer periods).
- Get comfortable: have water, snacks, notebook and pen, cushion, and extra layers to hand.
- You should have already received the meeting Agenda. We suggest those with smaller screens print it out so you can easily follow the structure. Flipping back and forth from the agenda to the online meeting on your screen breaks focus on the group – and risks technical glitches.
- Your name will auto appear so make sure it's yours and not someone else who uses the computer. If it's not automatically yours, try editing your display name (e.g. in Zoom, you can do this by clicking the 3 dots in the corner of your video). This will allow the host or other participants to refer to you directly by name when they want to.

During - guidance to help you take part

- This is a big meeting so the host will ask you to mute your audio during any presentations. This is to keep background sound to a minimum. They will explain how to do this.
- If the host puts you on mute, but you want to interject, we will tell you how to indicate this. If it is appropriate for participants to jump in and comment verbally, you can unmute yourself by clicking the 'unmute' button.
- When speaking in online meetings, particularly medium-large ones, it is best to say your name before making your point. Otherwise it can be difficult for the other participants to distinguish who is saying what on a screen of small faces.
- Always be patient and try to speak one-at-a-time. It is likely that people will start talking over each other at some point, particularly as sometimes there can be a delay, but it's important to be respectful and ensure everyone has opportunity to have their say.
- If you're struggling with getting to grips with being in an online meeting – don't worry! Try to engage with the meeting the best you can, and contact your meeting host after the event to help talk you through any worries or difficulties you faced in the session.
- At the end please fill in the feedback form/survey sent to you so we can learn and improve

After - knowing what to expect

The follow up to an online meeting should be fairly similar to normal.

- Your meeting host should share any notes/minutes from the meeting with you and all other participants.
- Please disseminate key info/share action points with your wider team.
- Please note any agreed action to help you achieve necessary action before the next meeting.

Suggested feedback form for bigger meetings

Name (optional)	
Date and meeting	

Before

1. The advance material was helpful

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
I disagree I agree

2. The purpose of the meeting and agenda were clear

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
I disagree I agree

During - comfort

1. The pace of the meeting was...

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
Too slow About right Too fast

2. The meeting length was....

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
Too long About right Too short

3. The number of breaks were...

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
Too few About right Too Many

4. When it comes to the online meeting technology

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
I need more help I will be fine once I am familiar with it I am fine with it

During – content

1. The meeting was well structured

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
I disagree I agree